

c.900–200_{BCE}

ETRUSCANS

Before the rise of Roman civilization a people known as the Etruscans flourished in Etruria, an area of Italy corresponding broadly to modern Tuscany. The origin of the Etruscans is uncertain but they are thought to have come from Asia Minor. By the 7th century _{BCE} these people had established a wide-reaching commercial network and were trading all over Europe. As a result, Etruscans enjoyed a comfortable lifestyle and the means to dress up – as paintings, sculpture, and pottery, mostly recovered from the burial sites of the wealthy, testify. Their clothes combined influences from both Greece and Asia and included garments that later became classic items of Roman wear. For example, the colourful *tebenna*, a wide, embroidered cape that was worn throughout Etruria, evolved into the Roman toga. The purple robes of later Roman emperors were also worn in Etruria.

ACCESSORIES

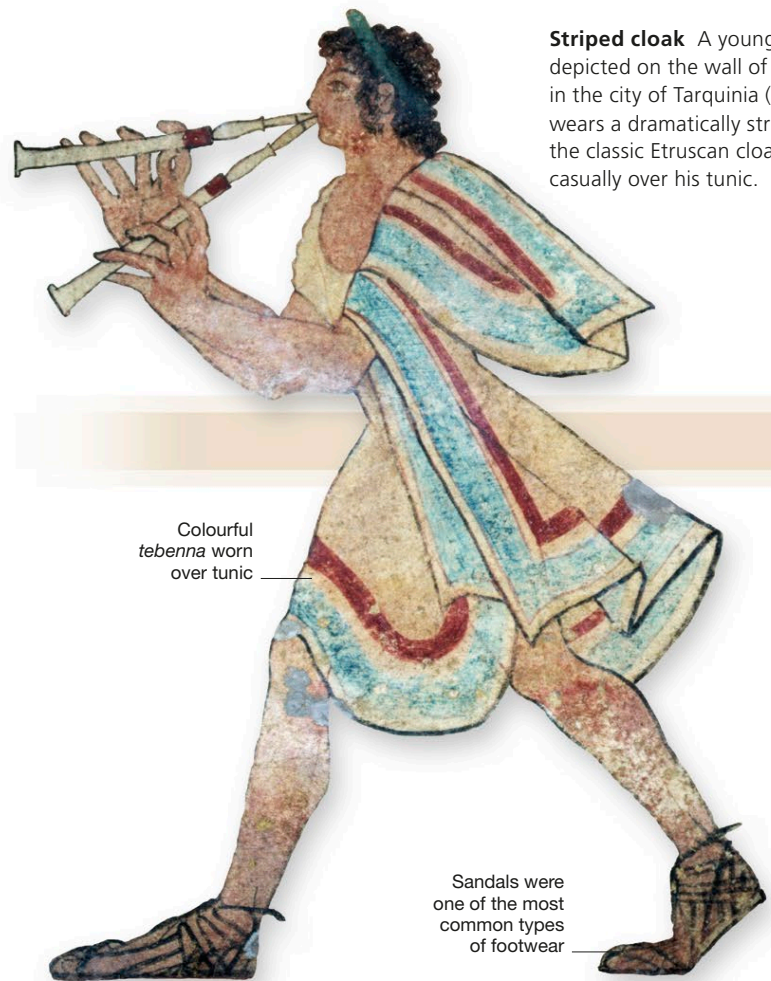


Gold pendant
(portraying Achelous,
the river god) c.6th
century _{BCE}



Leech-shaped gold
brooch, c.7th century _{BCE}

The highly skilled Etruscan jewellers created marvellous accessories in bronze, silver, and gold. These included pendants, bracelets, necklaces, earrings, bracelets, clasps, and brooches. A gold-working technique known as granulation was developed, whereby tiny grains of gold were soldered on to a smooth background to create a glittering effect. Some of the showiest pieces date from the 7th century _{BCE}. Between the 6th and 4th centuries _{BCE} the work was fine but less extravagant. Around 550_{BCE} engraved gemstones were imported from Greece.



Striped cloak A young musician, depicted on the wall of a tomb in the city of Tarquinia (c.500_{BCE}), wears a dramatically striped *tebenna*, the classic Etruscan cloak, flung casually over his tunic.

Colourful
tebenna worn
over tunic

Sandals were
one of the most
common types
of footwear



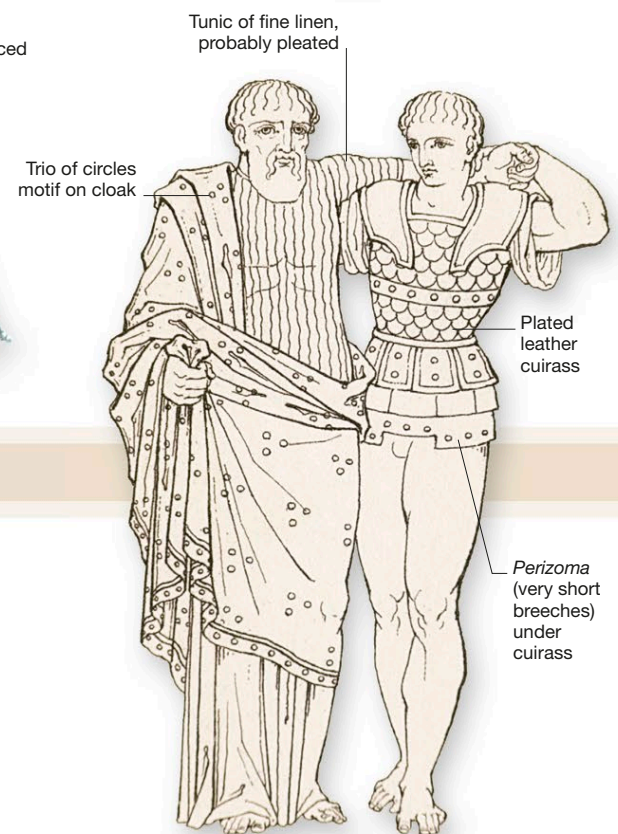
Minoan-influenced
hairstyle

Coloured
border

Long
chiton
(gown)

Pointed
boots

Dancing clothes Paintings in the Tomb of the Jugglers at Tarquinia (c.500_{BCE}) depict various entertainers. This dancer wears pointed boots and a *chiton* with a contrasting border. Bracelets and large, disc-shaped earrings complete her costume.



Tunic of fine linen,
probably pleated

Trio of circles
motif on cloak

Plated
leather
cuirass

Perizoma
(very short
breeches)
under
cuirass

Age and youth This Thomas Hope line illustration shows an older man wearing a cloak with the trio of circles motif often seen in Etruscan art. However, the younger man's leather armour is more imaginative than authentic.